

Less cookies for the Dutch

The Dutch Parliament passed a law that requires a website to take permission from the visitor before storing a cookie on their device.

Report: Violent games reduce crime

The incapacitation effects outweigh the negatives of aggressive behaviour stemming from violent games, a research has led to conclude.

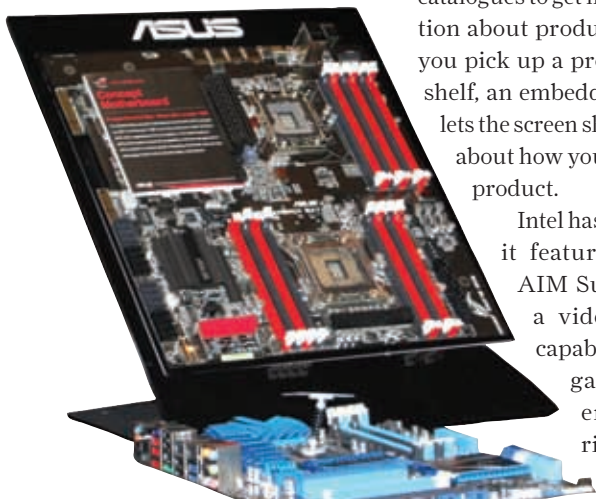
the first AMD motherboard to support 3-way SLI as well as CrossFireX multi-GPU set-ups. SupremeFX X-Fi 2 audio and Intel Ethernet with GameFirst technology round up the specs.

Next up are the new Intel Z68 chipset-based ROG Maximus IV Extreme-Z and ROG Maximus IV GENE-Z motherboards. Of the two, the Maximus IV Extreme-Z is the full-fledged ATX overclockers board, while the Maximum IV GENE-Z is the microATX version, perfect for case modders.

The two new graphics cards, the ROG MATRIX GTX 580 and dual-GPU MARS II/2DIS/3GD5, are both based on Nvidia GeForce GTX 580 GPUs, and both offer 19-Phase Super Alloy Power technology for better overclocking stability.

Amongst all the regular stuff, we also chanced upon the Danshui concept board based on a fusion of the X58 and X79 chipset while accommodating two processors; one an LGA 2011 socket and the other an LGA 1366 ! A small glimpse of the future right here.

The Danshui concept board features a fusion of the X58 and X79 chipsets housing both LGA2011 and LGA1366 sockets!



Trend-spotting

One of the biggest trends was Android being ported to other devices, the most important from a consumer's point of view being networked HD media players. While cruising from booth to booth, we came upon several innocuous little booths featuring such products. Westin AmLogic Enjoy TV showcased its Android TV. It has USB ports on the side for attaching external hard drives, as well as an SD card slot. The device shows an Android FroYo user interface and it comes with a very unique remote control (Air Mouse), which you can wave in the air and see the pointer on the screen. The remote also doubles up as a QWERTY keypad which can be used for typing out long sentences by holding the remote control in the landscape mode. Why would you need that? Well the UI has a browser amongst other things.

The other trend was embedded systems. In addition to announcing its Atom, Ivy Bridge and Medfield plans, Intel showcased its use of embedded technology in the field of digital signage. While shopping at a mall the Kinect enabled signage system lets you interact with it using gestures to browse catalogues to get more information about products. Imagine you pick up a product from a shelf, an embedded RFID tag lets the screen show you more about how you can use that product.

Intel has not just that, it features the Intel AIM Suite which is a video analytics capability that can gather viewership metrics such as gender, age

and show on the signage how long a customer has interacted with the product. Not only does this add a novelty factor to the otherwise boring digital signages, it also gives the advertisers hard numbers which will give them an idea of their return on investments. You can also use your smartphones to receive e-coupons with special offers from the advertiser.

Behind closed doors lies all the good stuff

As always at Computex, exhibitor's booths have this secret back room where only a few are invited. Yes, we're talking about the "NDA room" where products that the company doesn't yet wish to reveal to the general masses are showcased to a select few members of the media. On entering, you're first greeted by a big "no photography" sign board and a bevy of interesting products lined up along the wall.

The first NDA room we hit was CoolerMaster. The biggest object glistening under the glare of the lights was the humongous Cosmos II case. Almost like a cupboard, it features a 10-slot backpanel, 11 HDD bays, fan controllers, a carry grip and the works. We also saw the new avatar of the V8 CPU cooler with LCD and a vapour chamber cooler prototype.

We were also invited to preview a few products from ZOTAC. While we're not allowed to reveal too many



This was just to get your attention

details, ZOTAC has quite a few interesting products in store. One of them is the ZBOX VIA Nano. This little device, the size of a small box of Ferrero Rocher, is the non blu-ray iteration of the ZBOX (which we'd reviewed some months back, sporting the AMD E350 chipset).

The ZBOX Nano ships without an HDD but you can easily open up the device and add a laptop HDD. Speaking of internals, there are two versions of the Nano: One is based on the AMD Fusion APU while the other has a VIA chipset. The VIA one is the budget option. The Nano will come with a media center remote and the price is likely to be in the sub ₹10,000 range.

There was also the steroid injected version of the ZBOX (probably called XL) which features a GeForce GTX 480M integrated graphics card. The last thing showcased in this enclave was an "HDMI wi-fi" technology for streaming HD content wirelessly to a screen from the ZBOX. But we doubt they'll name it that though. Let's wait and watch. **d**